

Installing Visual Studio Community 2026 with C++ Development Tools

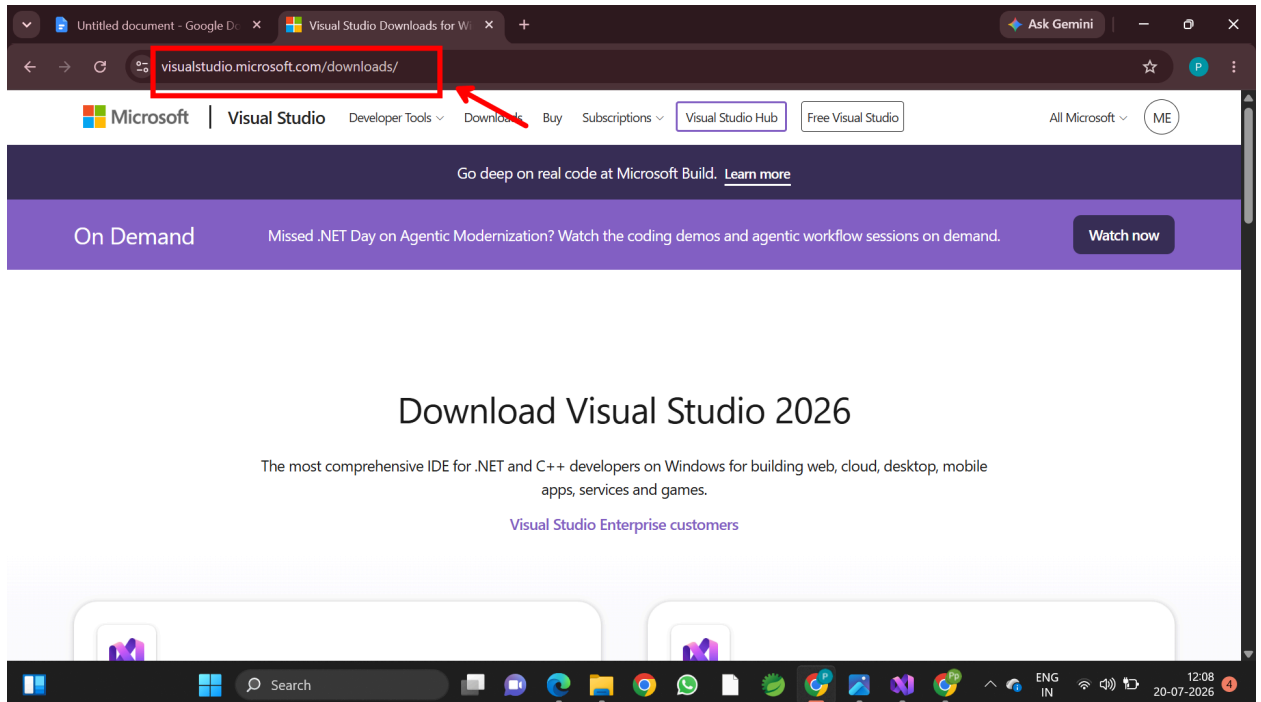
Step 1: Download Visual Studio Community 2026

Instruction:

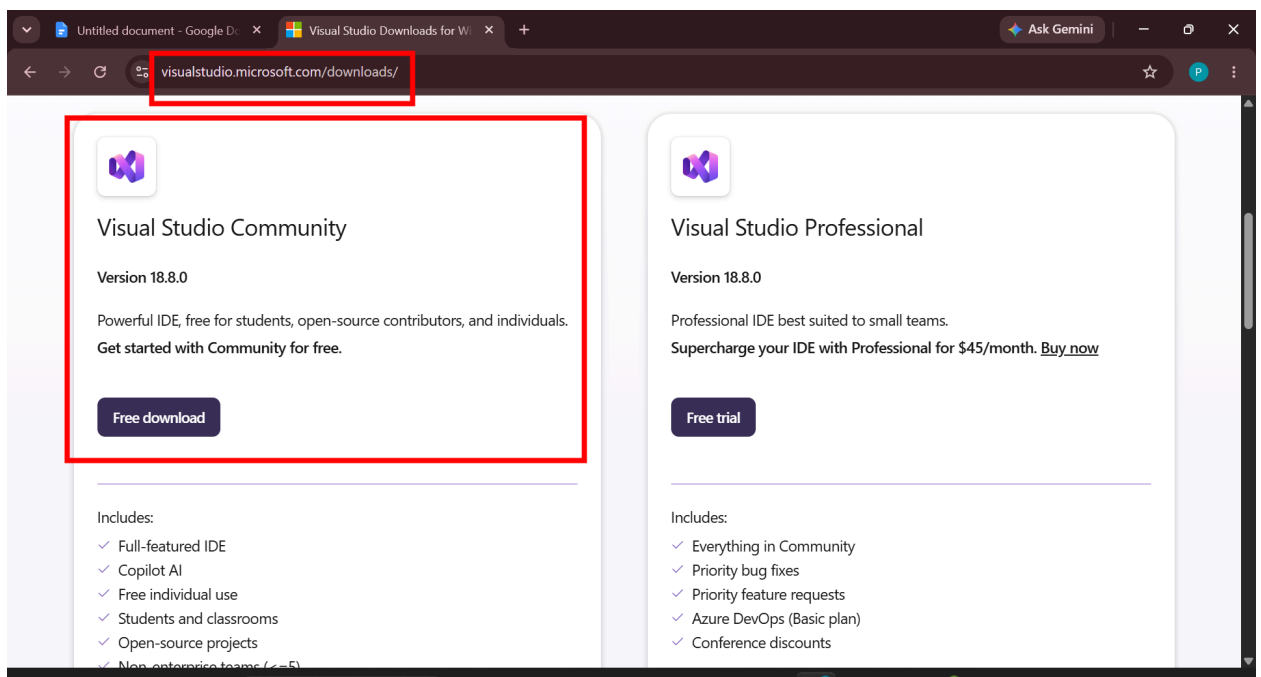
Visit the official Microsoft Visual Studio download page and download the **Visual Studio Community 2026** installer

Open your web browser and navigate to the official Microsoft Visual Studio Downloads page:

<https://visualstudio.microsoft.com/downloads/>



On the downloads page, locate the **Visual Studio Community** section and click **Download** to begin downloading the installer. After the download is complete, continue with the installation process.

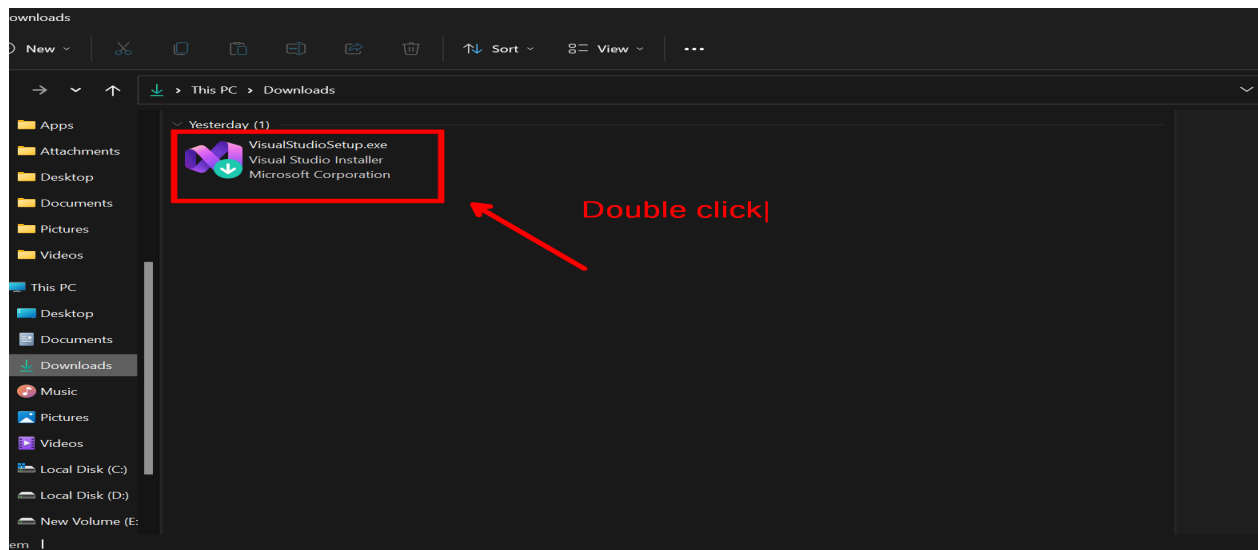


Note: Always download Visual Studio from the official Microsoft website to ensure you receive the latest version and security updates.

After the download is complete, save the installer to your computer.

Screenshot

- Microsoft Visual Studio download page showing the **Download Community** button.



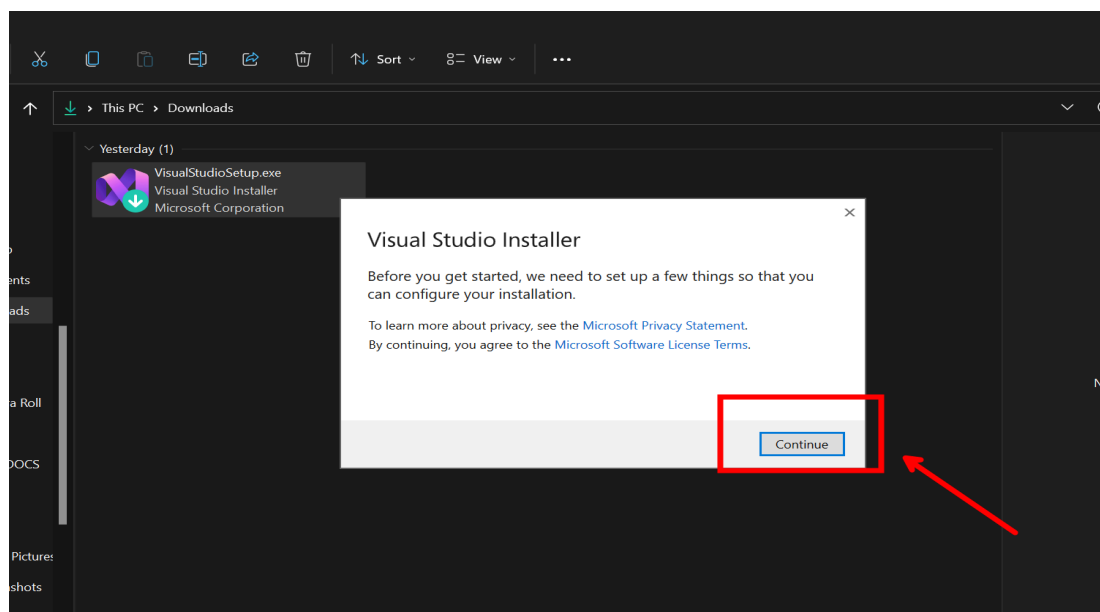
Step 2: Launch the Visual Studio Installer

Instruction

Navigate to the folder where the installer was downloaded and double-click **VisualStudioSetup.exe** to start the installation process. If the **User Account Control (UAC)** dialog appears, click **Yes** to allow the installer to make changes to your device

Screenshot

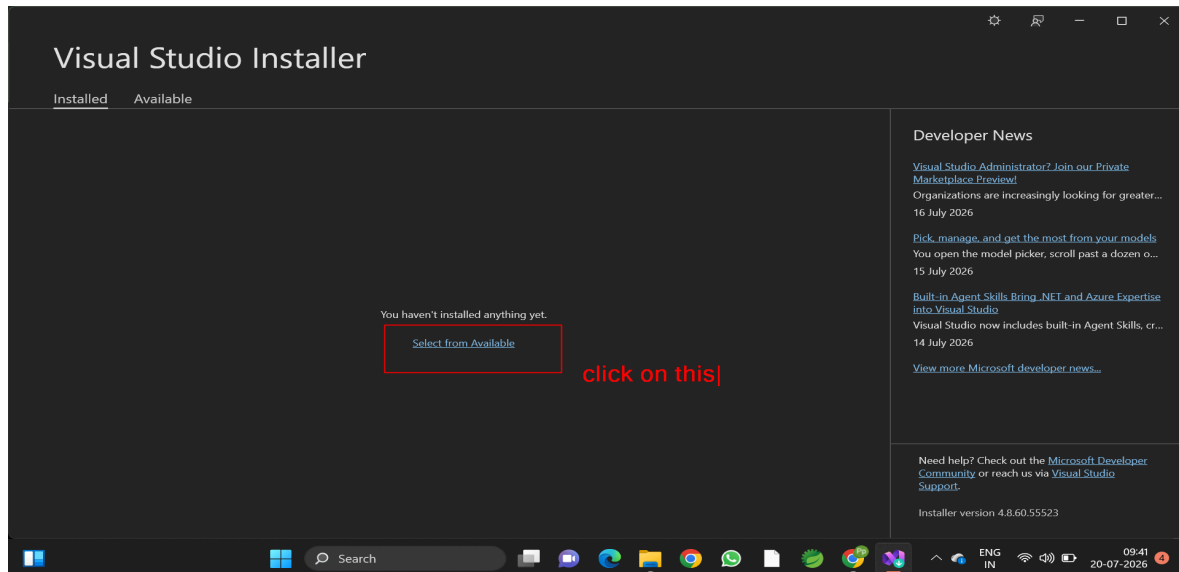
- File Explorer showing **VisualStudioSetup.exe**.
- User Account Control (UAC) dialog (optional).



Step 3: Open the Visual Studio Installer

Instruction:

After the Visual Studio Installer launches, select the **Available** tab. This section displays the Visual Studio editions that are available for installation on your computer Visual Studio Installer with the **Available** tab highlighted.



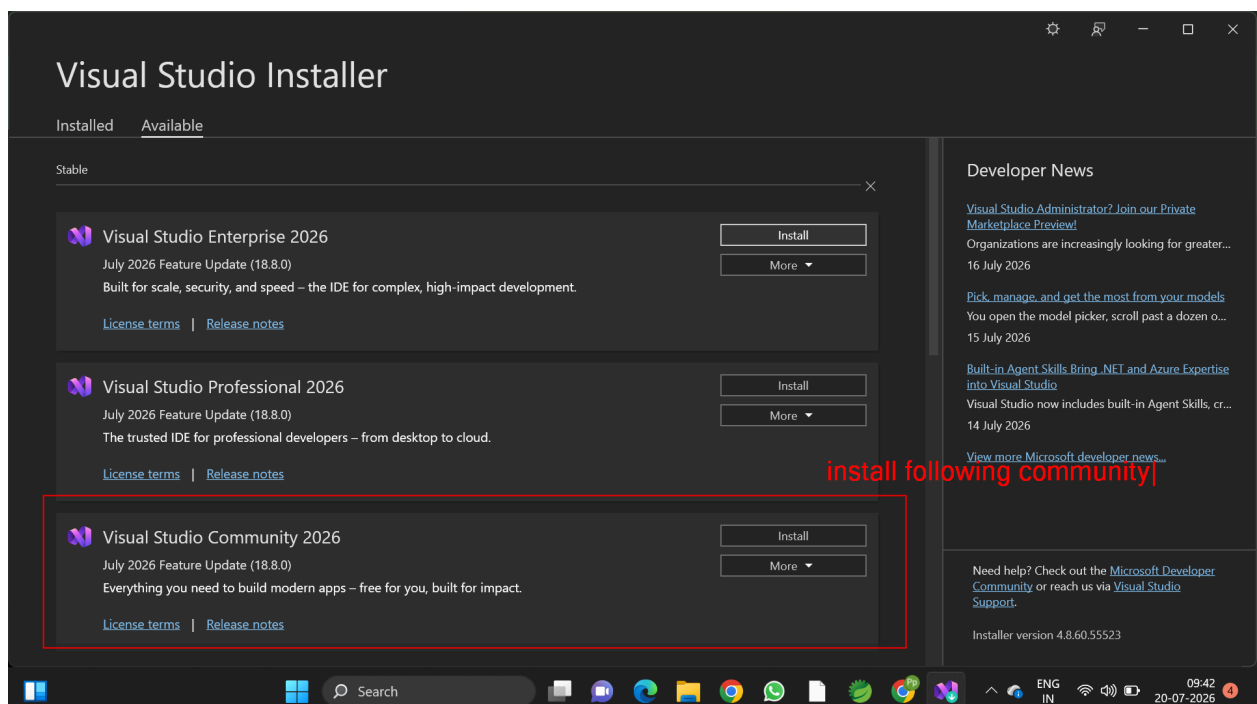
Step 4: Install Visual Studio Community 2026

Instruction

Locate **Visual Studio Community 2026** in the list of available products and click **Install**. The Visual Studio installation wizard will open, allowing you to select the required workloads and components.

Screenshot

- Visual Studio Installer displaying **Visual Studio Community 2026** with the **Install** button.



- **Select the Required Workload**

Step 5: Choose the C++ Workload

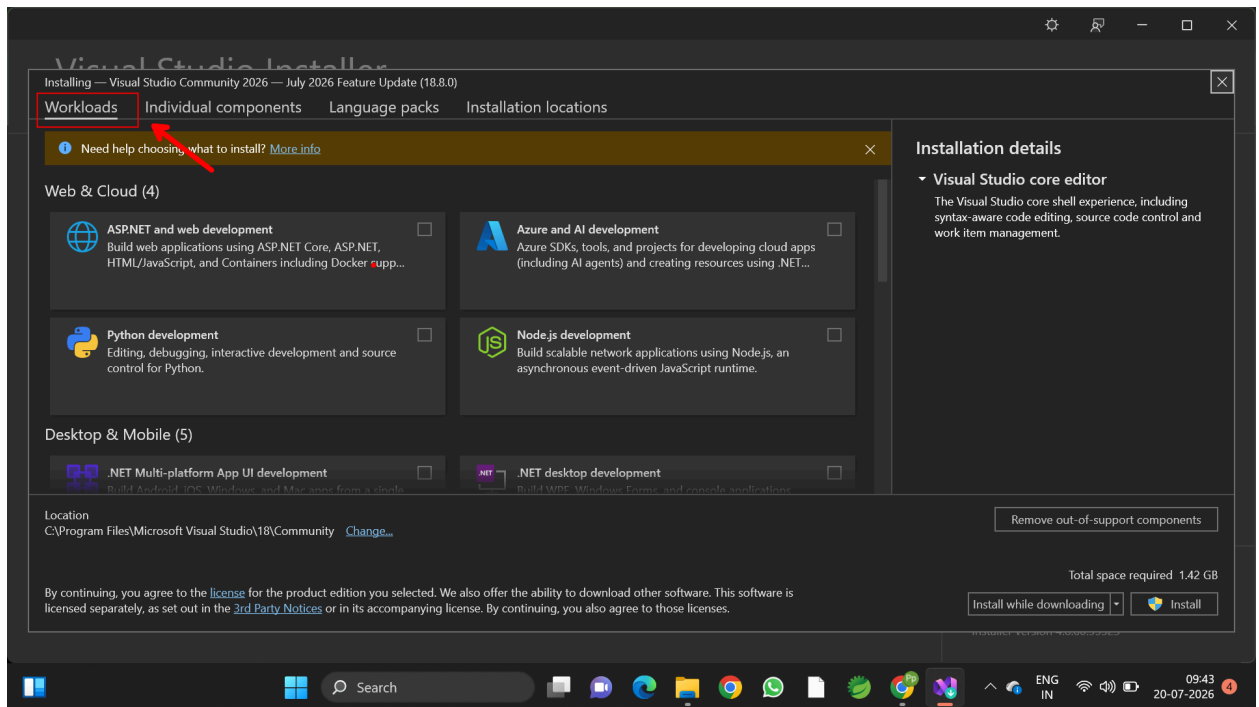
Instruction

On the **Workloads** page, scroll to the **Desktop & Mobile** section and select **Desktop development with C++**. This workload installs the Microsoft Visual C++ compiler, Windows SDK, debugger, and other essential tools required for developing Windows-based C++ applications.

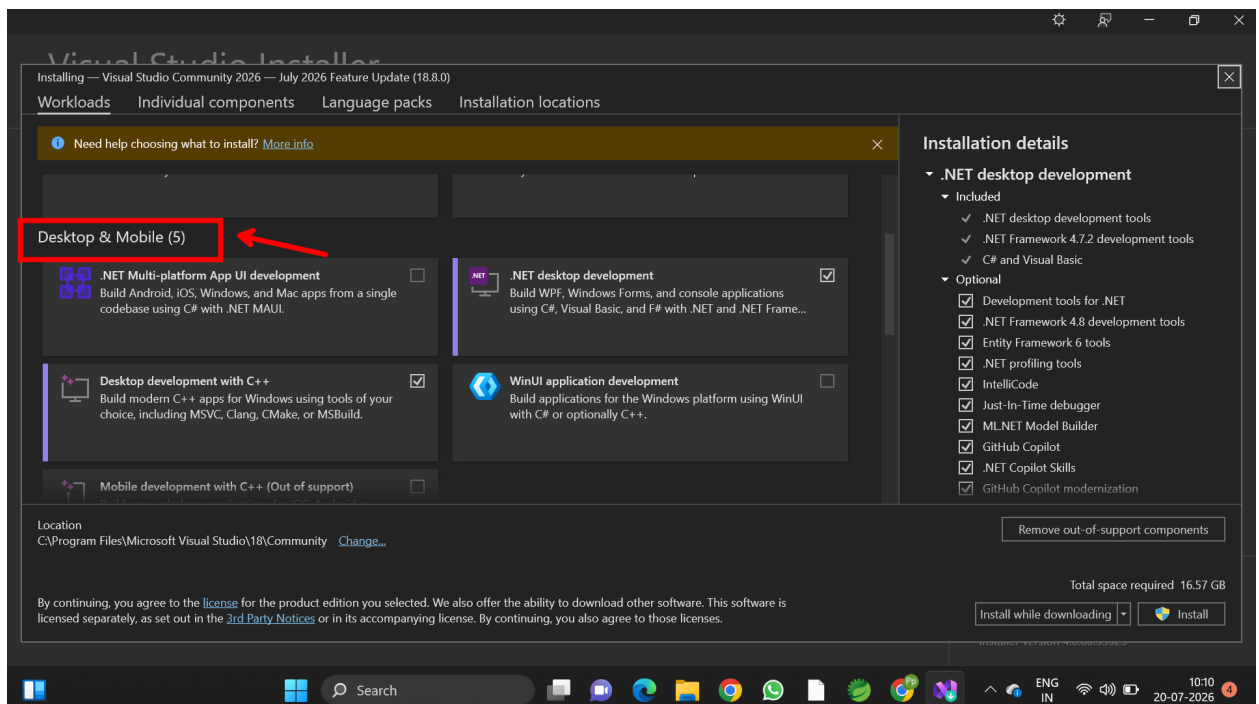
Important: The **Desktop development with C++** workload is required for C++ programming on Windows.

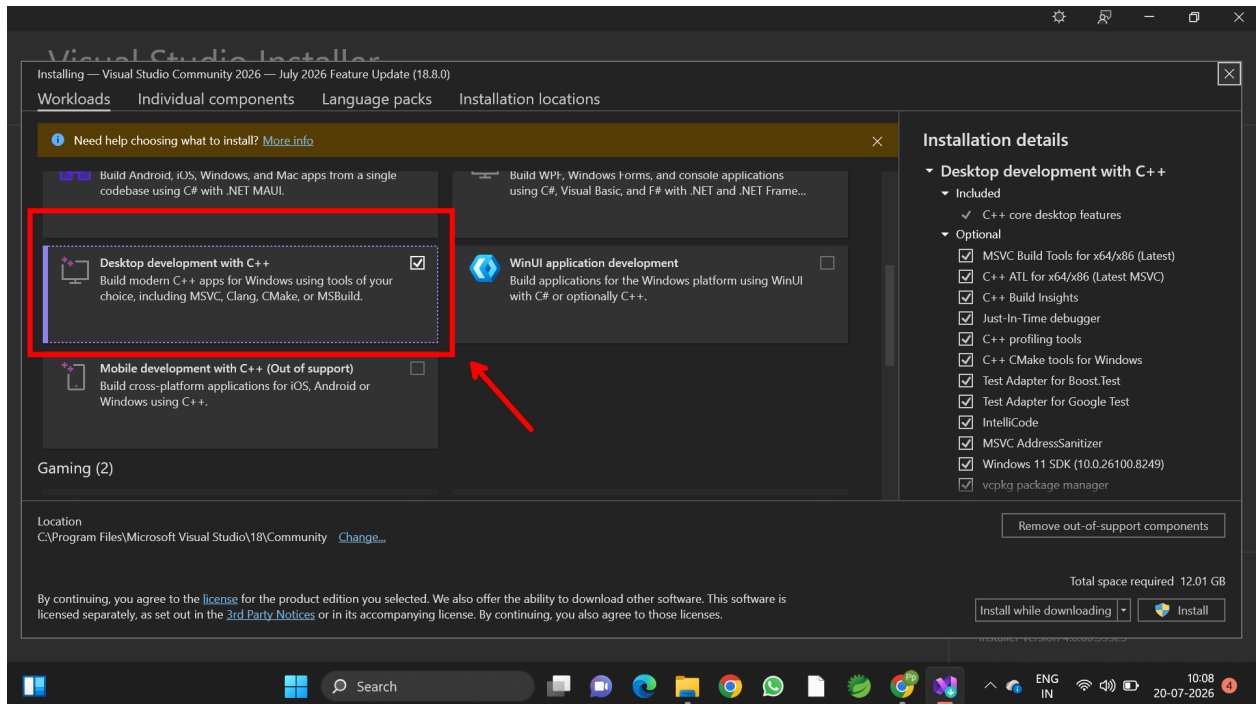
Screenshot

- **Workloads page**



Select Desktop development with C++

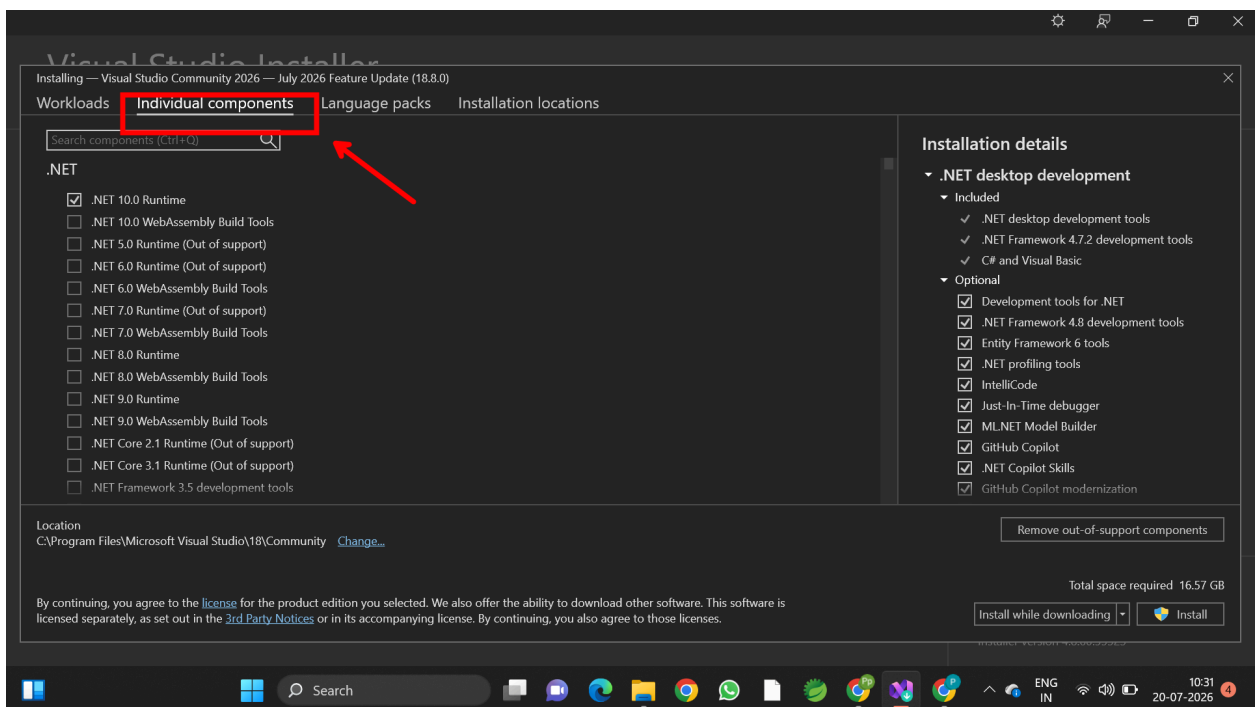




• Step 6: Verify the Required Components

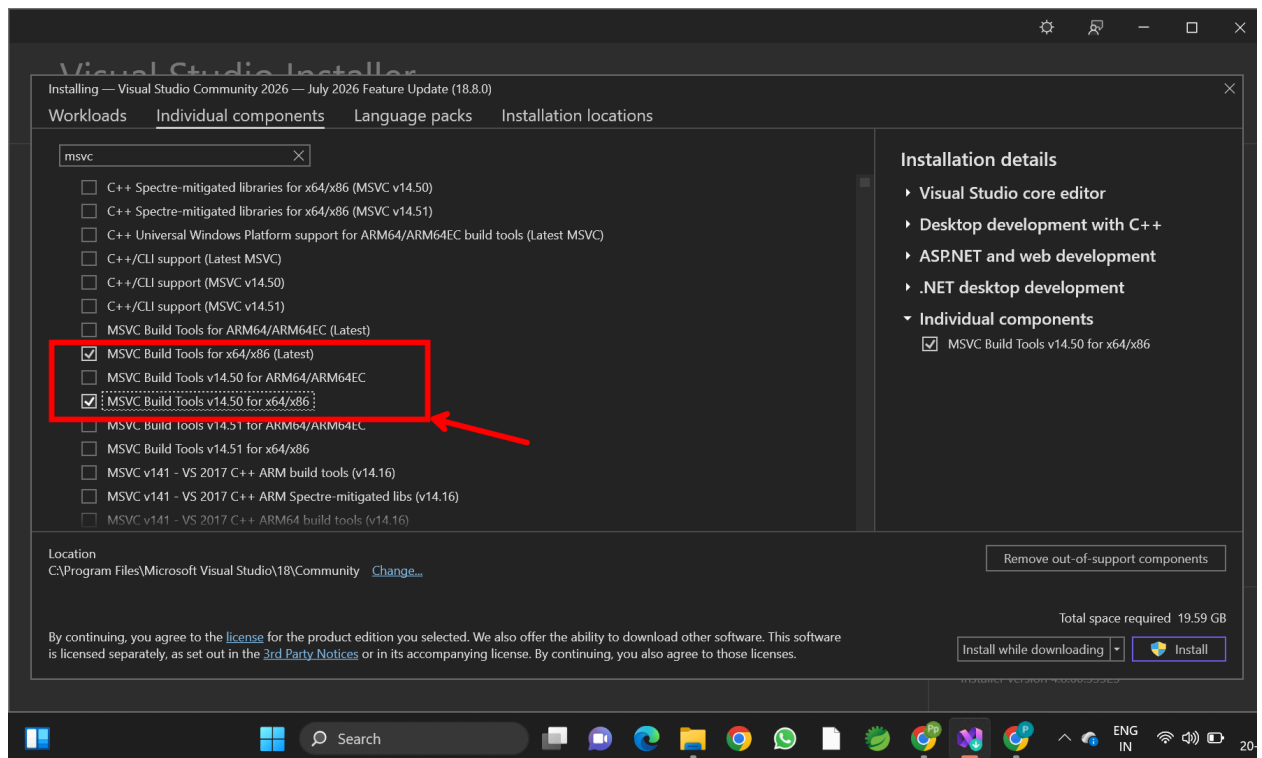
Instruction:

Select the **Individual components** tab and verify that the following components are selected. These components provide the compiler, SDK, and development tools required to build and debug C++ applications.



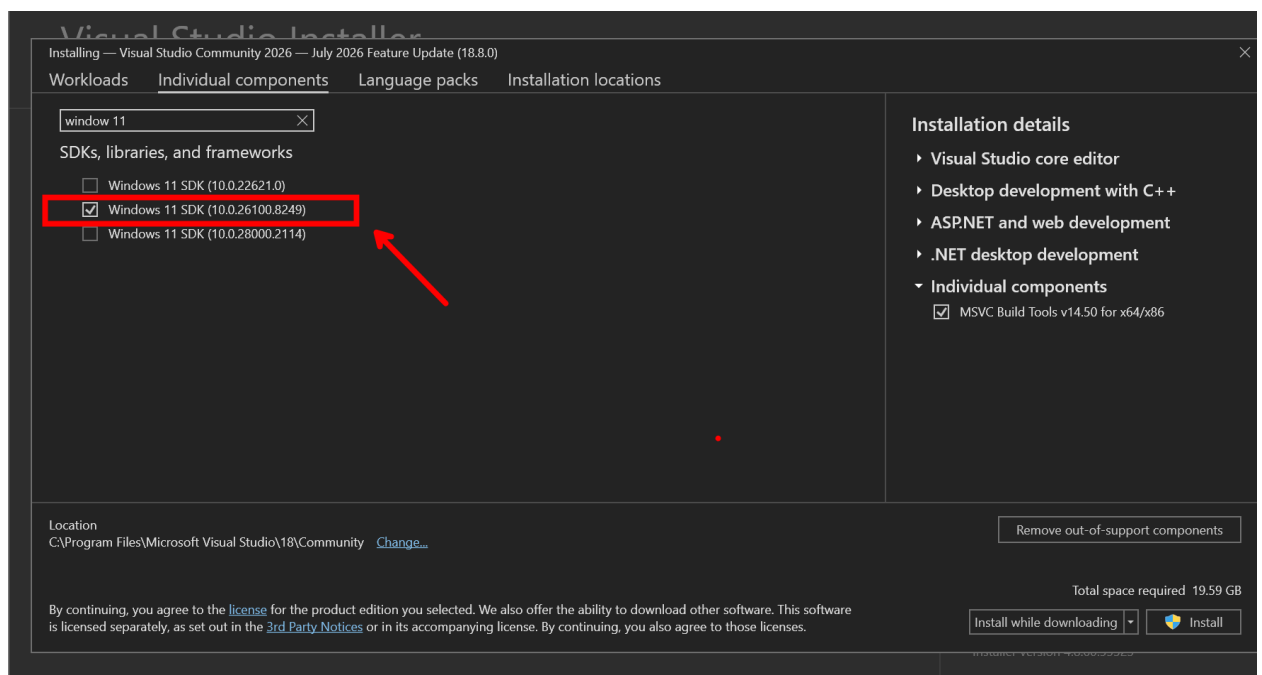
• Select the Component or verify the components

Component: MSVC C++ x64/x86 Build Tools (Latest Version) (installs the Microsoft Visual C++ compiler and build tools required to compile C++ applications)

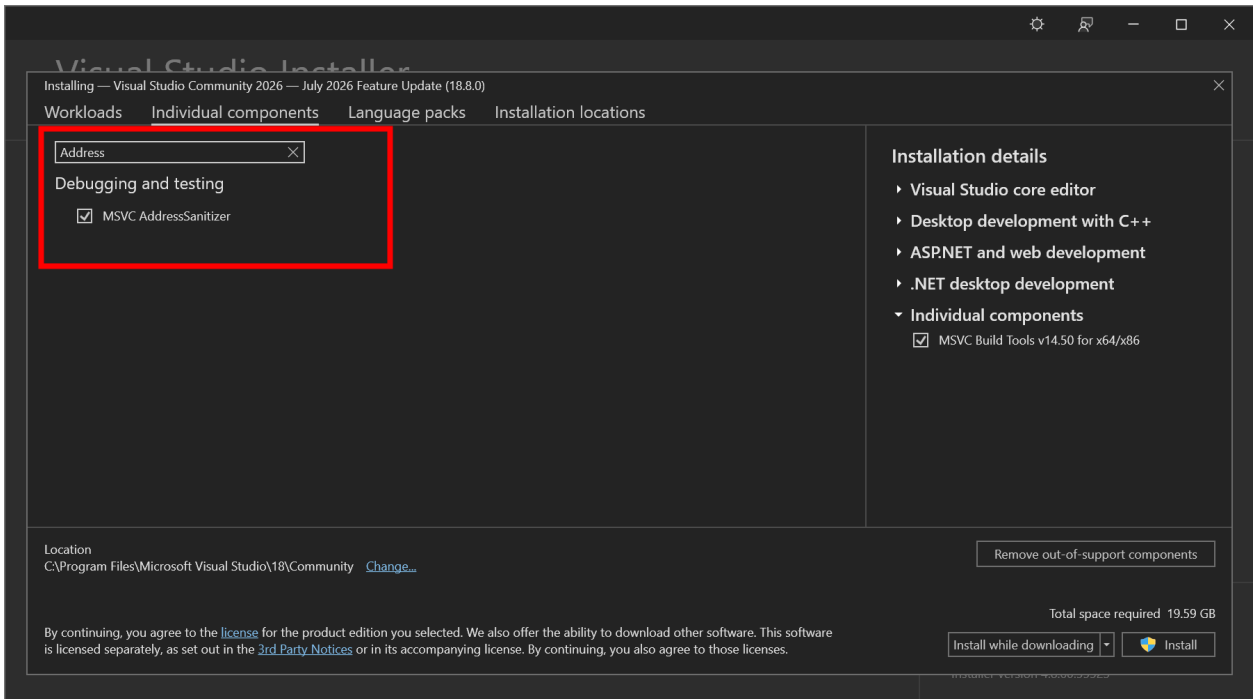


Note: If a newer version of the **MSVC C++ Build Tools** is available (for example, **v145** or later), select the latest version instead of an older release

Component: Windows 11 SDK (Latest Version) (provides the libraries and headers required to build Windows desktop applications.)

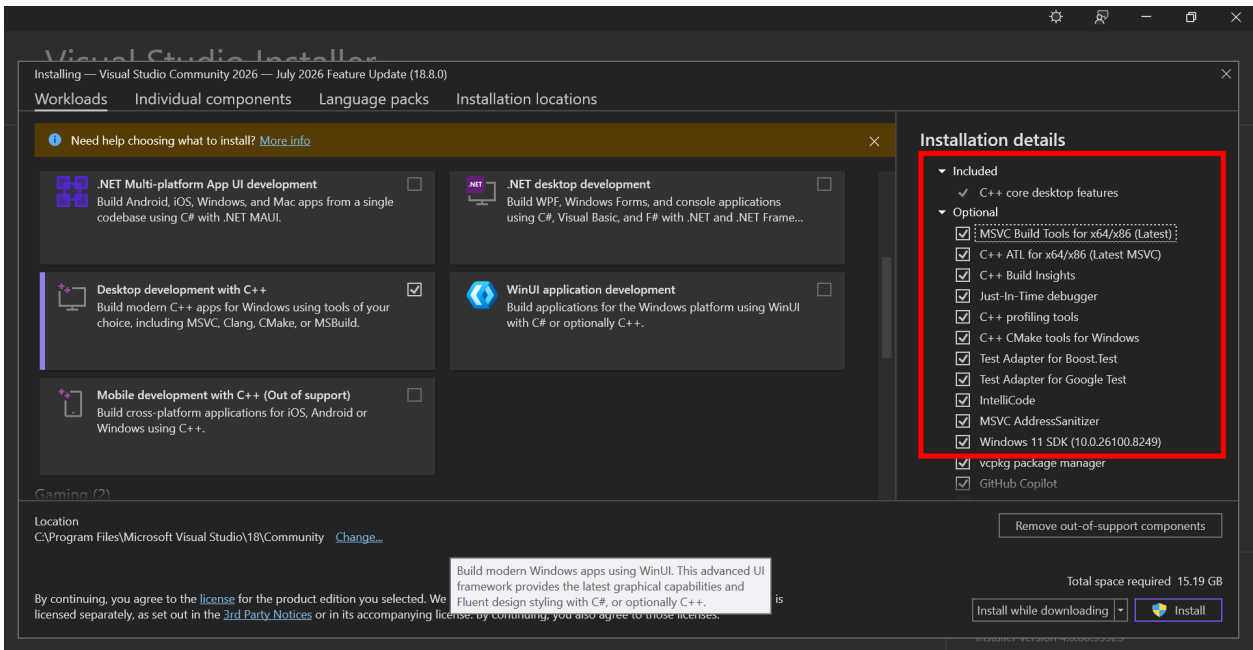


Component: MSVC AddressSanitizer :-Helps detect memory-related errors such as buffer overflows and invalid memory access during debugging. (optional but recommended)



Screenshot

- **Individual components** tab with the required components highlighted.

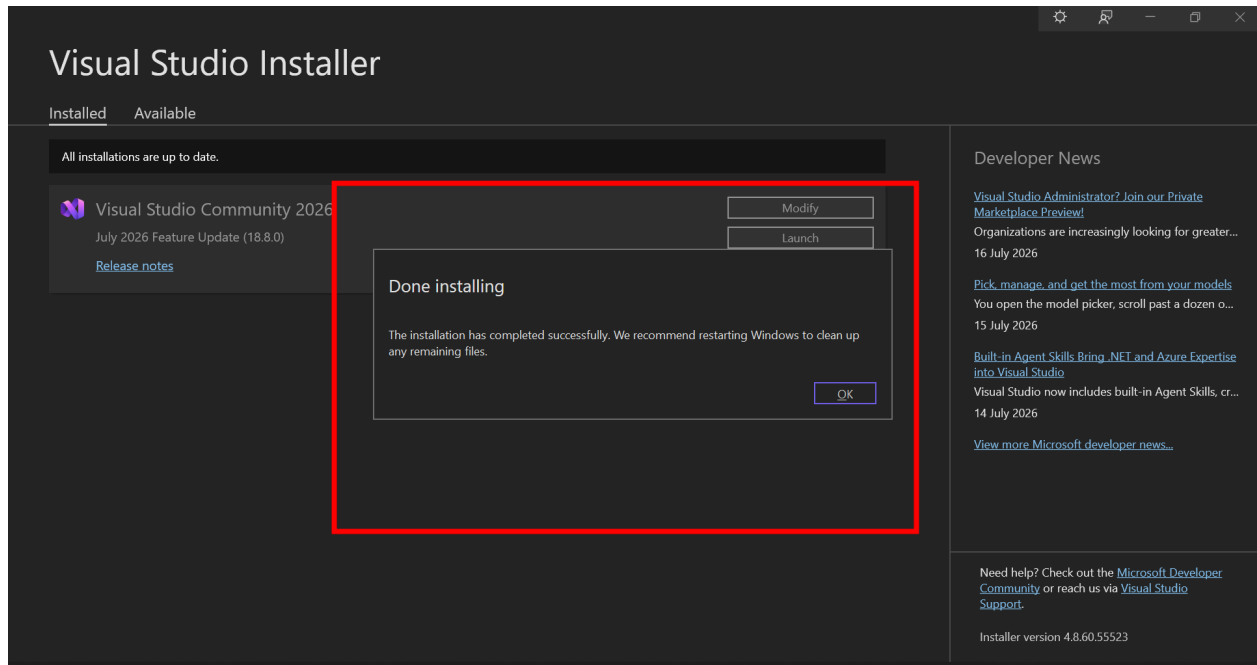


Step 7: Begin the Installation

Instruction

After confirming that the required workload and components are selected, click **Install** to begin the installation. The installation process may take several minutes depending on your internet connection and system performance.

- Bottom-right corner of the installer showing the **Install** button



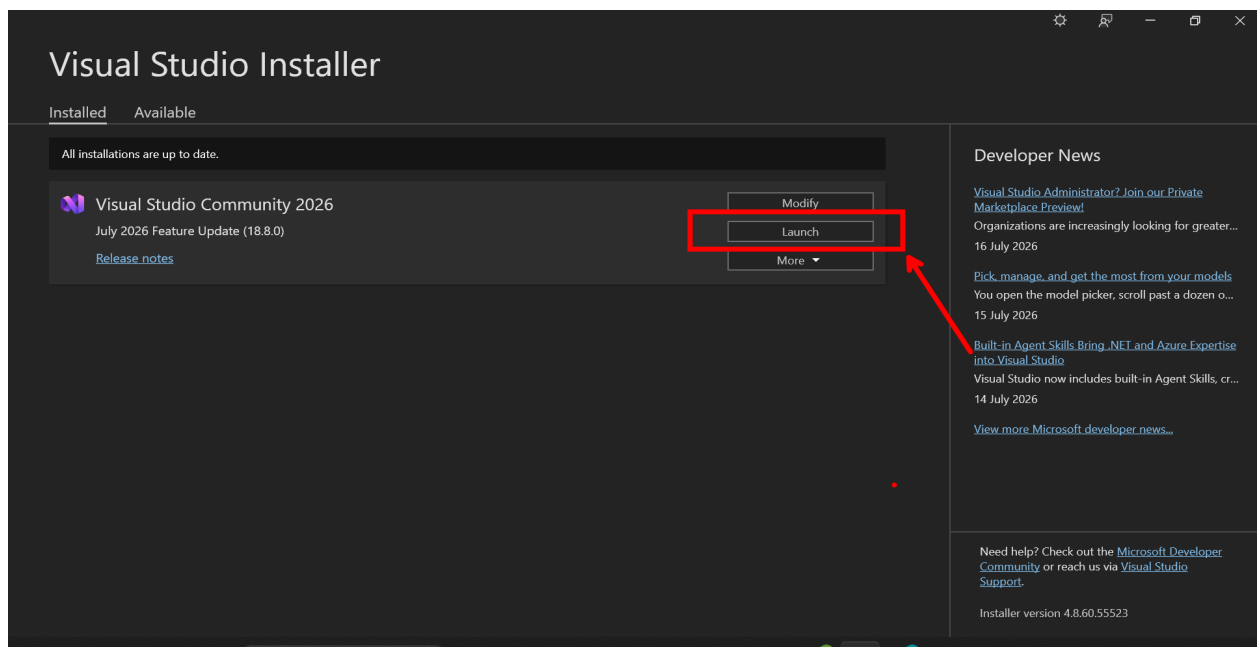
Step 8: Launch Visual Studio Community 2026

Instruction

Once the installation is complete, click **Launch** to start **Visual Studio Community 2026** for the first time.

Screenshot

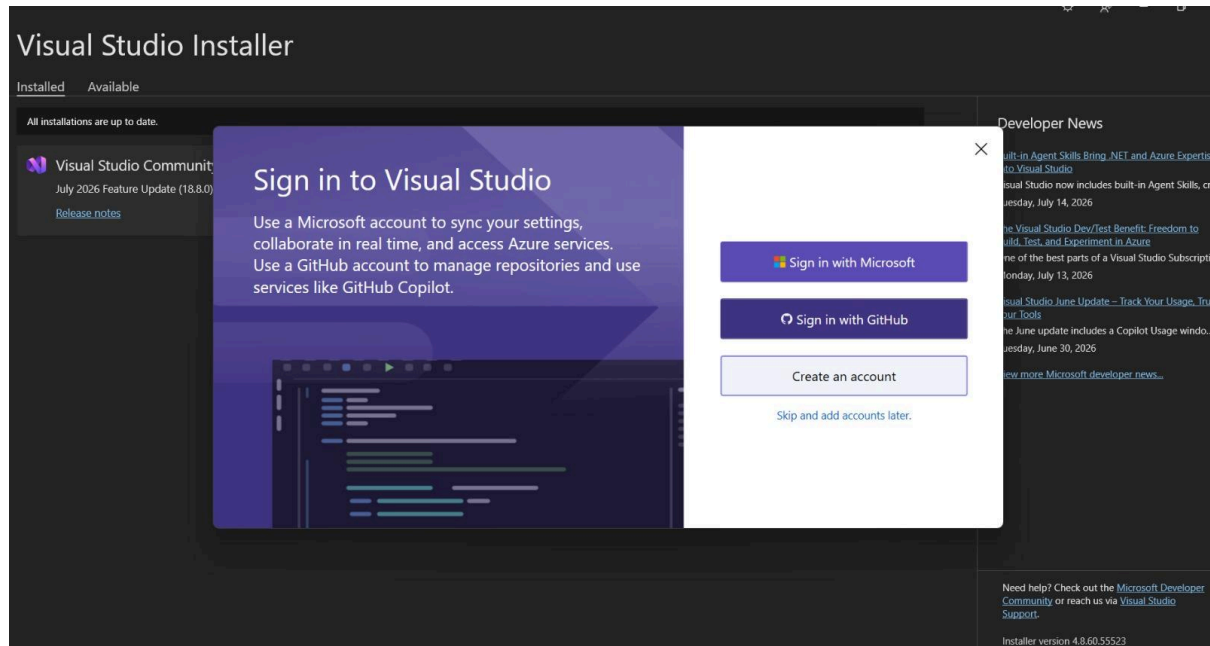
- Visual Studio Installer showing the **Launch** button.



Step 9: Sign In to Visual Studio (Optional)

Instruction:

When Visual Studio opens for the first time, you may be prompted to sign in with a Microsoft account. Signing in enables features such as settings synchronization and access to additional services. If you do not wish to sign in at this time, click **Skip for now** (if available) and continue.

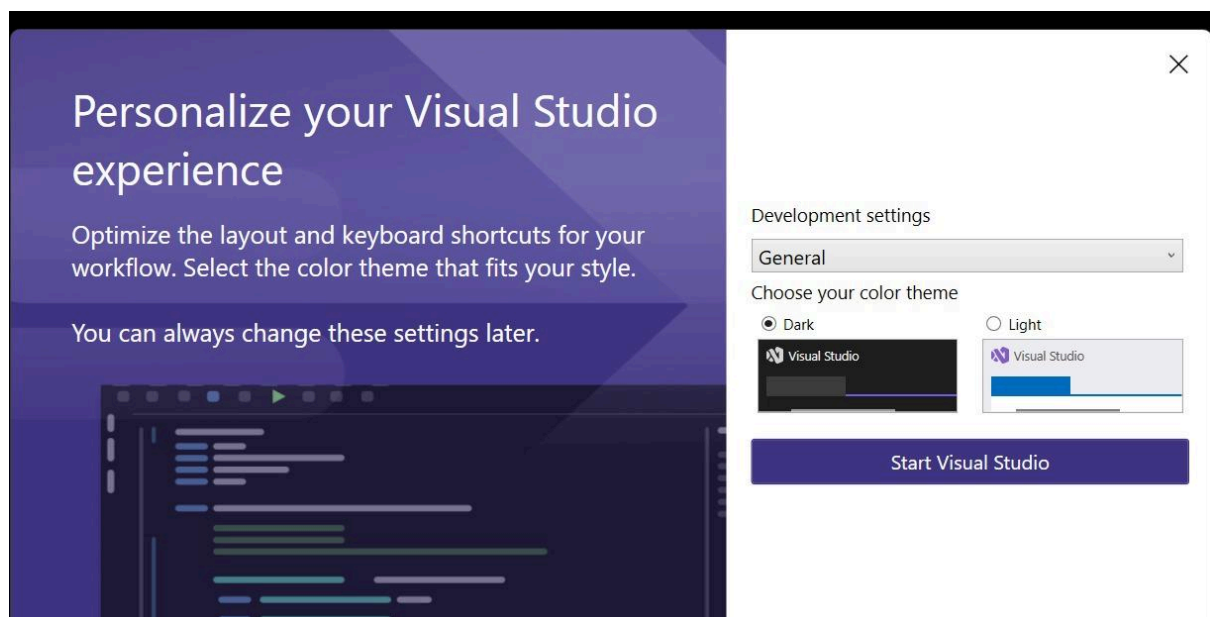


Note: A Microsoft account is recommended but is not required to begin creating C++ applications.

Step 10: Select Your Development Environment

Instruction:

Choose your preferred **Color Theme** (such as **Light**, **Dark**, or **Blue**) and click **Start Visual Studio** to complete the initial setup.



Note: The selected theme only changes the appearance of the Visual Studio interface and does not affect application development.

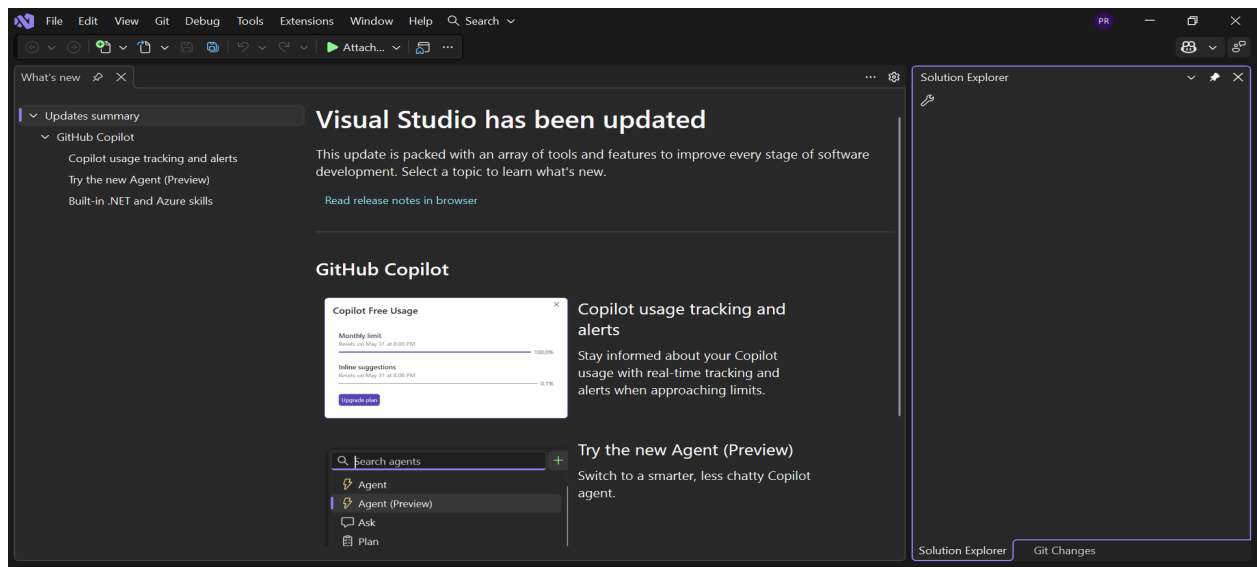
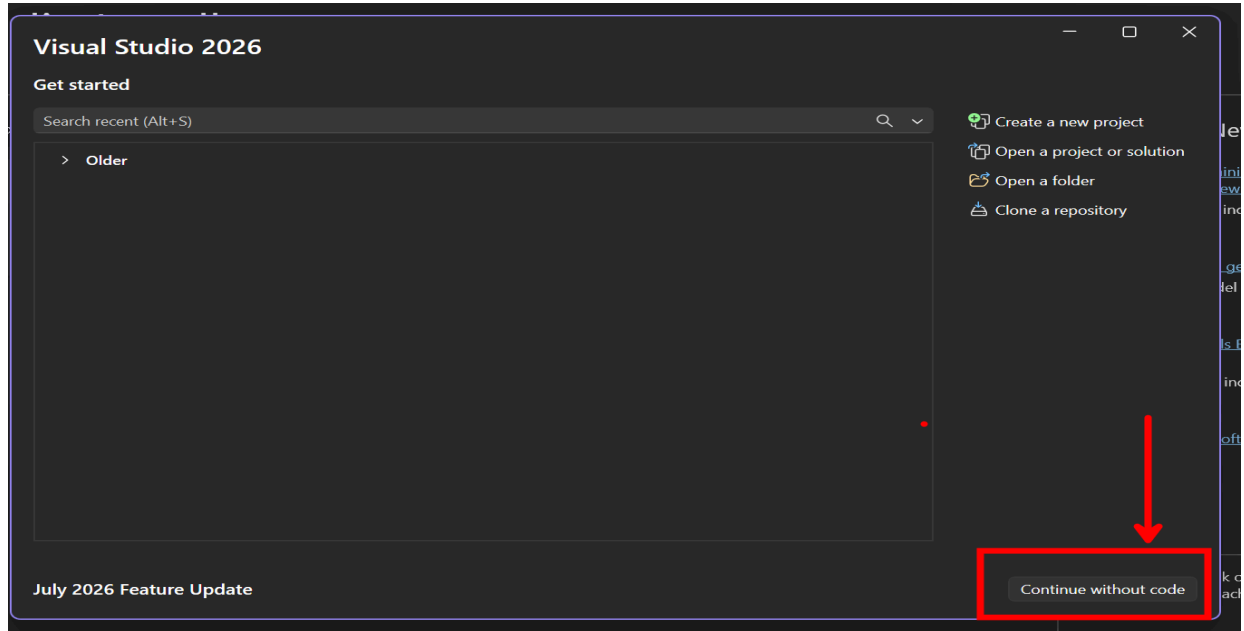
Step 11: Welcome to Visual Studio

Instruction

After the initial setup is complete, the Visual Studio Start window will appear. From here, you can create a new project, open an existing project, or clone a repository.

Screenshot

- Visual Studio Start window.



- Creating Your First C++ Console Application

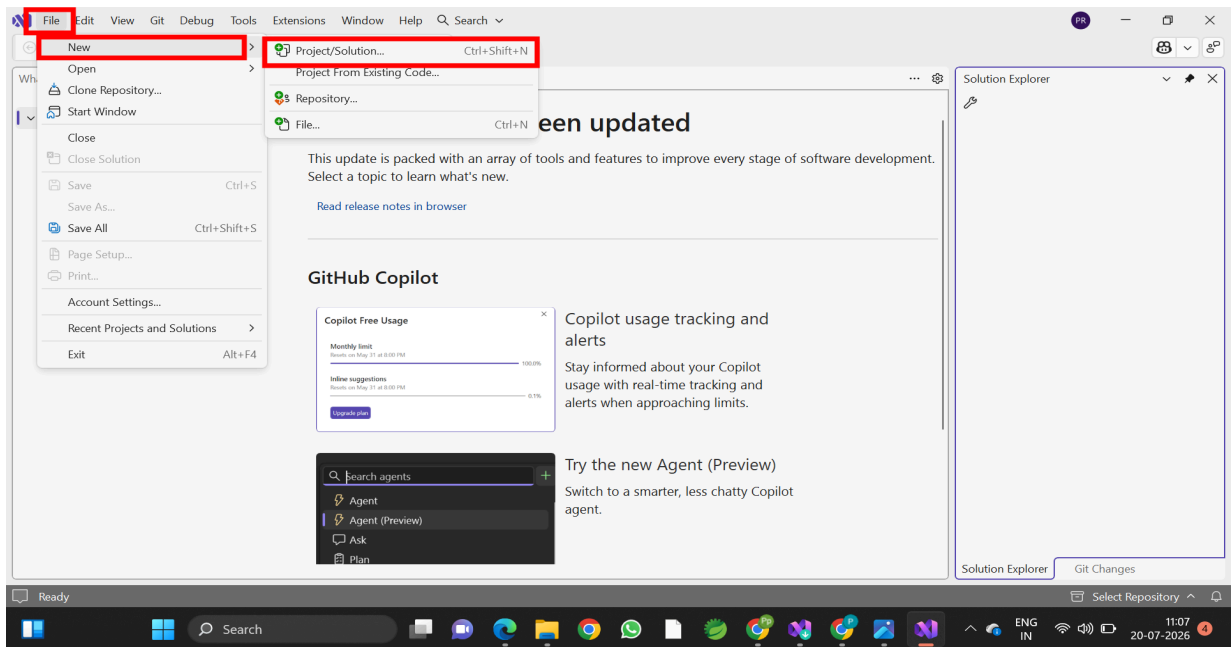
Step 12: Create a New Project

Instruction:

On the Visual Studio Start window, click **Create a new project** to begin creating a new C++ application.

Screenshot

- Visual Studio Start window with **Create a new project** highlighted.



Step 13: Select the Console App Template

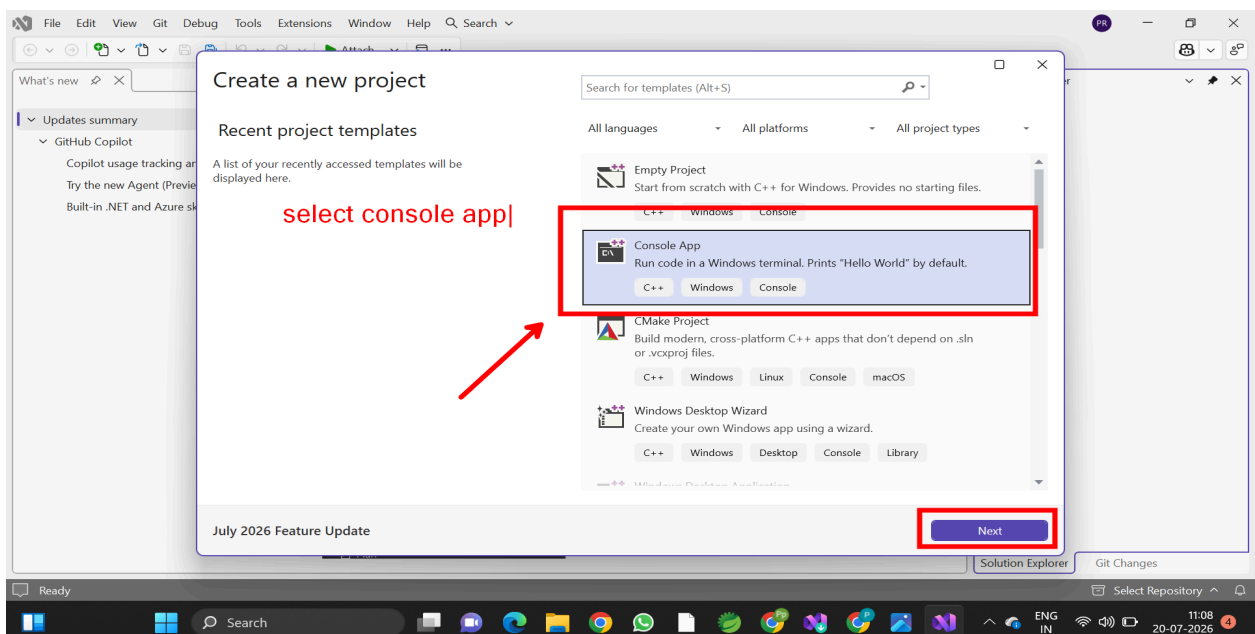
Instruction

In the **Create a new project** window, type **Console App** in the search box. From the list of available templates, select **Console App** with the **C++** language, and then click **Next**.

Note: Ensure that you select the **C++** template and not the C# or Visual Basic version.

Screenshot

- Create a new project window showing **Console App (C++)** selected.



Step 15: Configure the Project

Instruction:

Enter a **Project name** and choose a **Location** where the project will be saved. You may also specify a **Solution name** if required. After entering the project details, click **Next** or **Create**, depending on the Visual Studio version.

Example:

- **Project Name:** HelloWorld
- **Location:** Documents\Visual Studio Projects

Screenshot

- Configure Your New Project window with the Project Name field.

Configure your new project

Console App C++ Windows Console

Project name
HelloWorldApplication

Location
D:\Sunbeam\0226\ModularC++

Solution
Create new solution

Solution name ⓘ
HelloWorldApplication

☒ Place solution and project in the same directory

Project will be created in "D:\Sunbeam\0226\ModularC++\HelloWorldApplication\"

July 2026 Feature Update Back Create

Step 15: Configure Additional Project Settings

Instruction

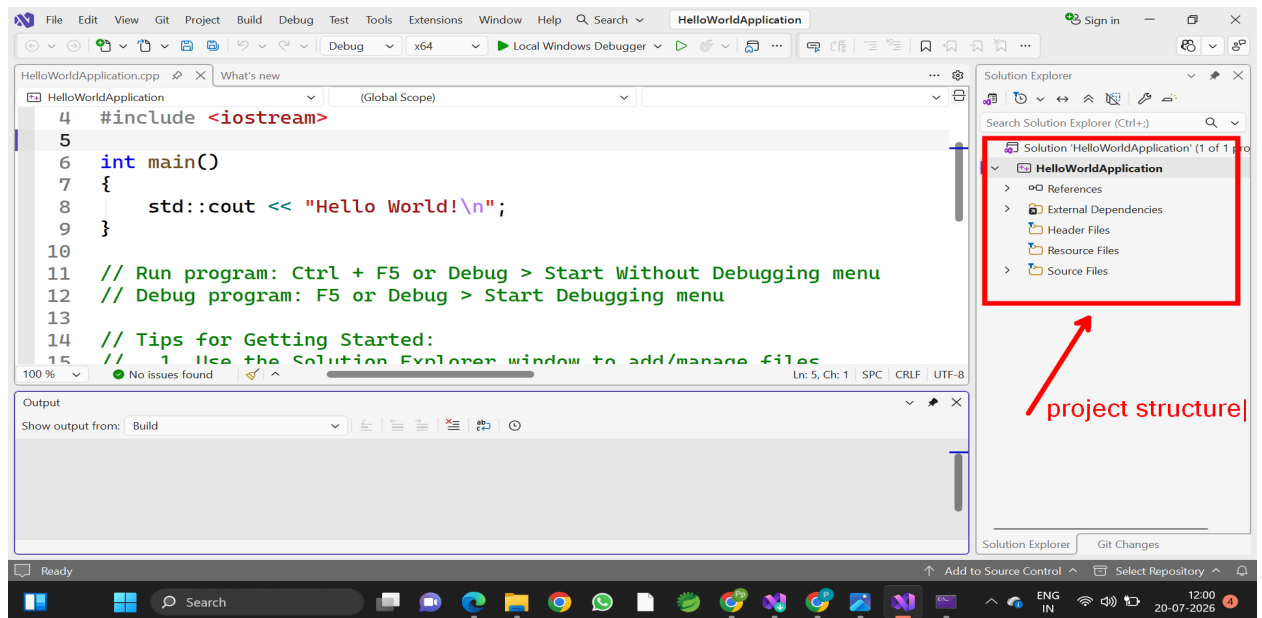
If prompted, review the project configuration settings. Keep the default options unless instructed otherwise, and click **Create** to generate the project.

Screenshot

- Additional Information page (if displayed).

Note: Some versions of Visual Studio may skip this step and create the project immediately.

Step 17: Write Your First C++ Program



Step 19: Build the Project

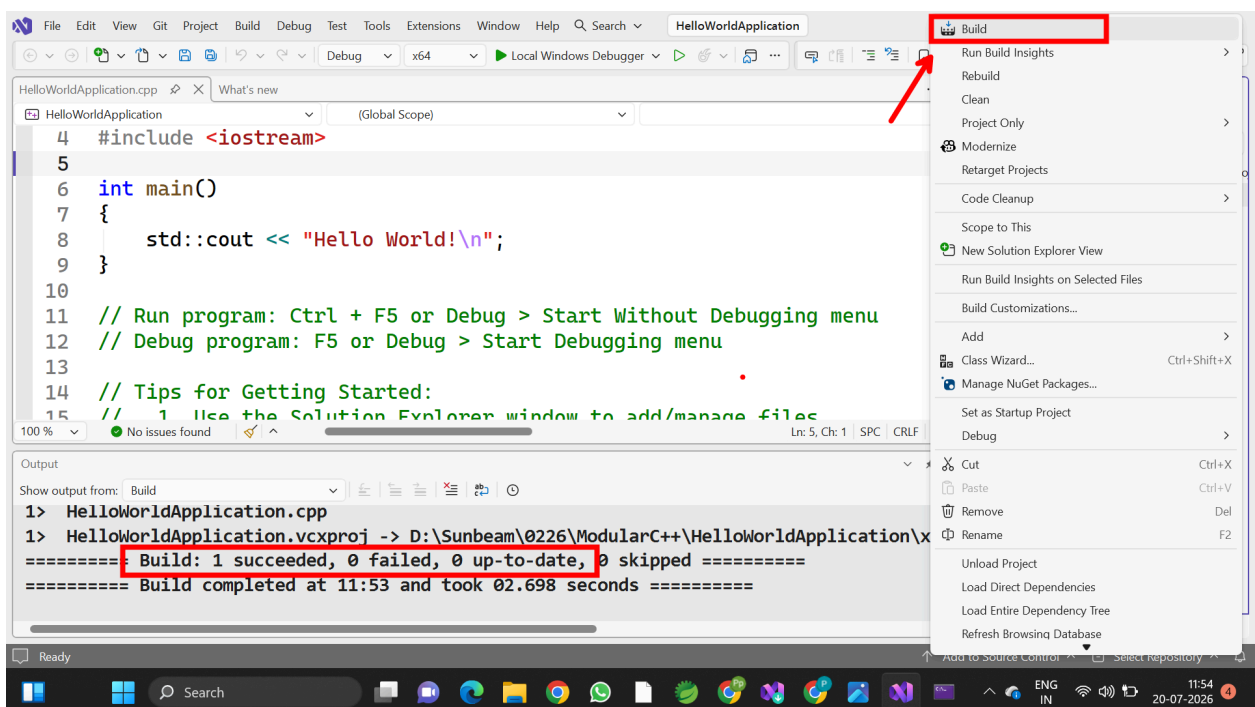
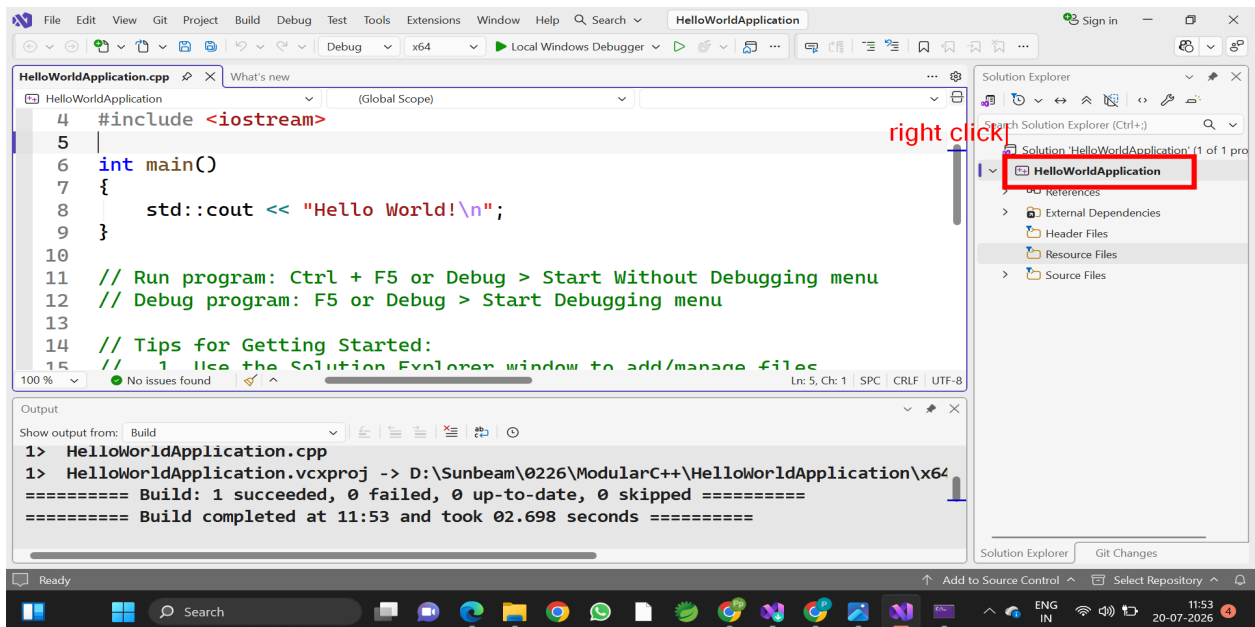
Instruction

From the **Build** menu, select **Build Solution**, or press **Ctrl + Shift + B**. Visual Studio will compile the source code and report any errors or warnings in the **Output** window.

Note: If the build completes successfully, you will see a message similar to **Build: 1 succeeded, 0 failed**.

Screenshot

- Build menu with **Build Solution** highlighted.
- Output window showing a successful build.



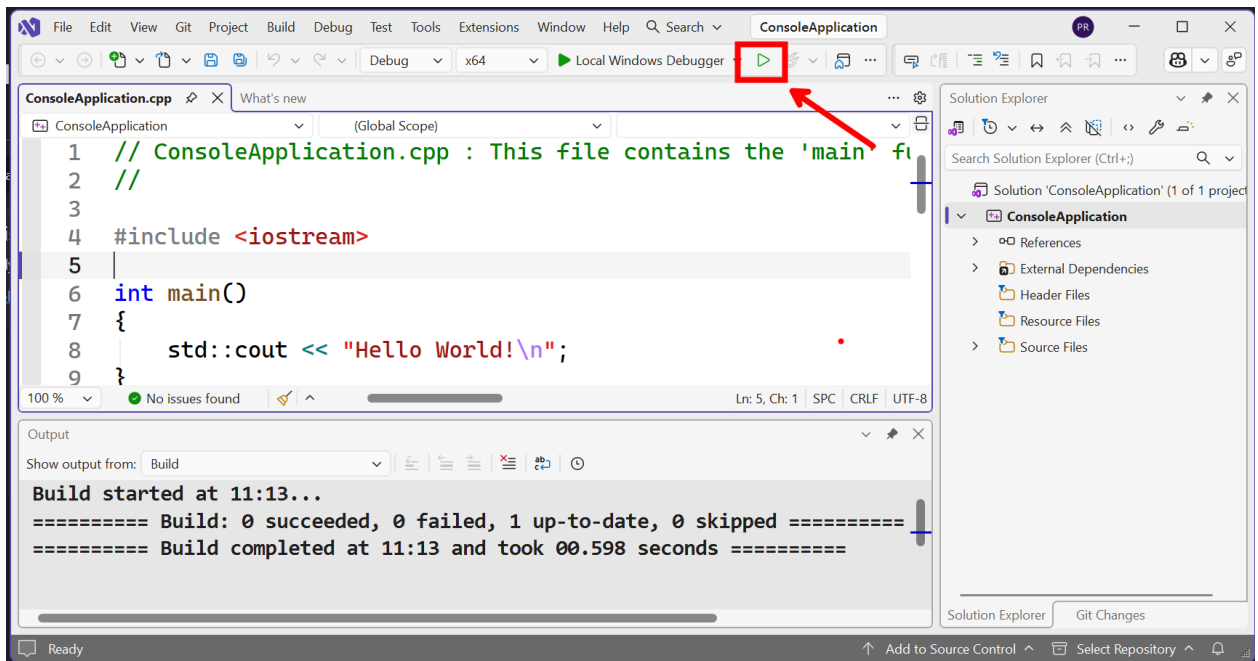
Step 20: Run the Application

Instruction

Click the **Start** button (▶) on the toolbar or press **Ctrl + F5** to run the application without debugging. A console window will open and display the program output.

Screenshot

- Start button highlighted.



Step 21: Verify the Output

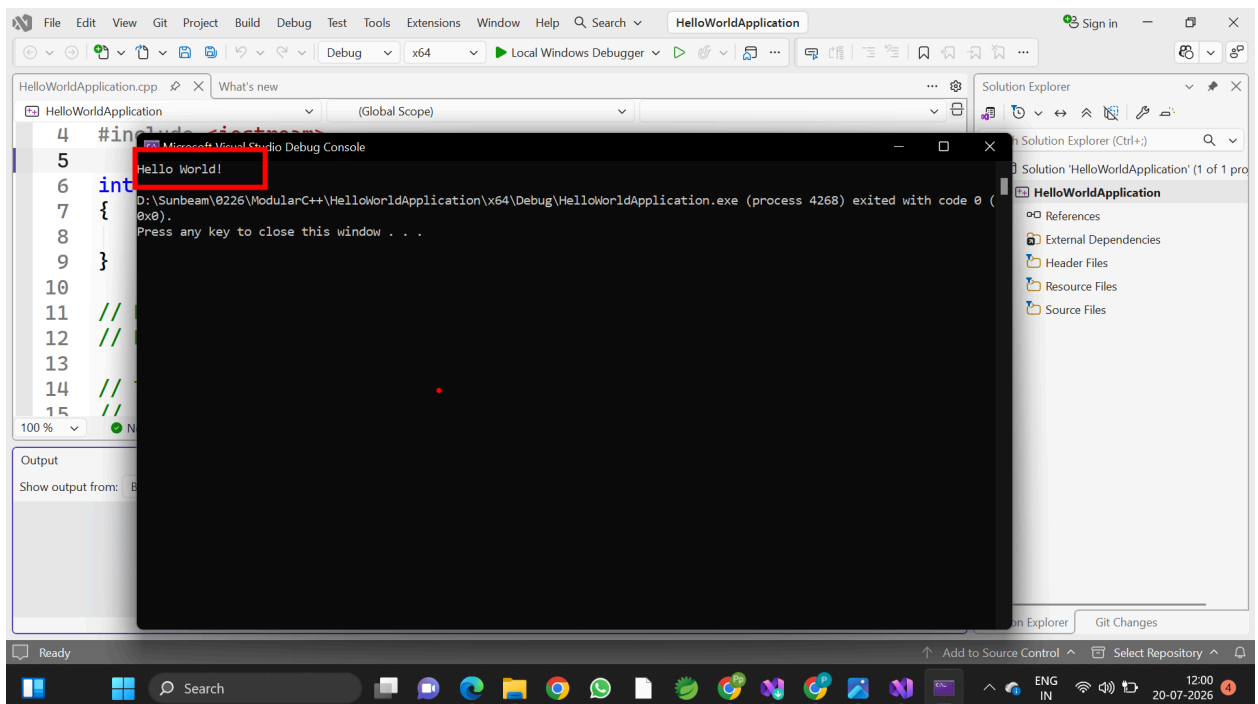
Instruction

Verify that the console window displays the following output:

Hello, World!

This confirms that Visual Studio and the C++ development environment have been installed and configured successfully.

Screenshot



- Console window displaying **Hello, World!**